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Suicide is now the leading cause of death in the 15-39 years age group in India, per a 2021 study published in *Lancet Psychiatry*

41%

The share of Indians who thought that people with mental health issues must reach out for support, which is much below the average of 83 per cent respondents for other countries, per a Unicef report

They are a whole cohort: young men and women who are familiar with the stresses of young life and have taken it upon themselves to help out other young people. India remains a country where mental health issues still invite jeers or judgement. In a 2021 Unicef-Gallup survey titled 'The State of the World's Children', which studied 20,000 children across 21 countries, the results from India were instructive—one out of seven Indians aged 15-24 years felt depressed or had little interest in doing things, just a little below the global median of one in five. However, what was more worrisome was that only a minority among them—just around 40 per cent in India compared to around 83 per cent in other countries—felt that those facing mental health issues should reach out for help. Equally disheartening were the findings of a *Lancet Psychiatry* study in 2021. Not only did India top the list in the number of suicides in the world, but suicide was also listed as the leading cause of death in the 15-39-year age group.

YourDost claims to have helped over 8,000 people to date. There is also We The Young, started by Charit Jaggi in 2019. A mental health awareness platform, it allows users to share their experiences with others. "We [the youth] are the largest demographic in the country," says Jaggi, 29, adding, "But our problems are unheard and underrepresented in society.... Today, the youth are more aware and open to conversation [than the previous generations], but